

The Noble Recollection of the Buddha

Ārya-buddha-anusmṛti · Toh 279 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་སངས་རྒྱལ་སྐྱེས་དྲེན་པ།

The Noble Recollection of the Buddha, known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-buddha-anusmṛti and in Tibetan as Pakpa Sangyé Drénpa, is a short devotional text belonging to the broader tradition of buddhānusmṛti, or mindful recollection of the Buddha's qualities. It enumerates the sublime attributes of the buddhas and serves as a support for contemplative practice centered on calling the Buddha to mind. The text is Toh 279 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the general class of dhāraṇī and ritual texts, and it was translated from Sanskrit into Tibetan by the Indian preceptor Surendrabodhi together with the great editor-translator the monk Yeshé Dé.

Translated by the Indian preceptor Surendrabodhi and the great editor-translator the monk Yeshé Dé, who rendered, revised, and finalized it.

In the language of India: Ārya-buddha-anusmṛti. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Recollection of the Buddha.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

The blessed buddha, the Blessed One, is a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly and fully awakened buddha — endowed with knowledge and conduct, a Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of persons to be tamed, Teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a Blessed One. Those Tathāgatas are endowed with an accumulation of merit properly gathered; their roots of virtue are inexhaustible; they are adorned with patience; they are the foundation of the treasuries of merit; they are beautified by excellent minor marks; their major marks bloom like flowers; their range of conduct is perfectly harmonious; when seen, there is nothing discordant; those who are devoted and inspired are filled with delight; they are not overwhelmed by the brilliance of wisdom; they are unwearied in their powers; they are the Teacher of all sentient beings; they are the father of bodhisattvas; they are the king among noble persons (āryas); they are the caravan leaders for beings journeying to the city of nirvāṇa; their wisdom is immeasurable; their eloquence is inconceivable; their speech is perfectly pure; their voice is melodious; beholding the beauty of their form, one is never sated; their form is matchless; they are unstained by desires; they are untainted by forms; they are unmixed with the formless; they

are fully and utterly liberated from the aggregates; they are not possessed of the elements; they have restrained the sense sources; their knots have been utterly cut through; they are fully liberated from all torment; they are thoroughly released from craving; they have crossed over the river; their wisdom is perfectly complete; they abide in the wisdom of all the blessed buddhas of the past, the future, and the present; they do not dwell in nirvāṇa as a fixed abode; they abide at the ultimate limit of perfect reality; regarding all sentient beings with the gaze of...

Translator's Notes

- The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end of the supplied passage, ending with "regarding all sentient beings with the gaze of" — the Tibetan closes with an incomplete phrase and the translation has been left open accordingly.

The phrase rendered "they do not dwell in nirvāṇa as a fixed abode" (mya ngan las 'das pa la mi gnas pa) refers to the Mahāyāna doctrine of non-abiding nirvāṇa (apratiṣṭhita-nirvāṇa), in which the buddhas neither remain in conditioned existence nor settle into a quiescent nirvāṇa, but continue to act for the benefit of beings. This is a significant doctrinal point preserved in the translation.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.